

did my best, every day, more than I was asked to do, better than I was expected to do it, my future would take care of itself.

25

Full disclosure: I feel compelled to acknowledge that I've deferred some of my own compensation, a widespread practice among senior executives of most of our corporations. The deferred amounts compound tax-free but the final value of the account will be fully taxed when withdrawn. (Some deferred compensation plans accrue interest not at the going rate—as my own does—but at annual rates as high as 13 percent!) Both situations call for reform, with limitations on accumulated deferrals to a reasonable amount, and with the rate of interest to be accrued limited to the market interest rate.

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Former President Bill Clinton has expressed the idea well. "People the world over have always been more impressed by the power of our example than by the example of our power."

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In the penultimate line of the poem, I've taken the liberty of revising Tennyson's words. He actually wrote, "*made weak* by time and fate, *but* strong in will." He never could have imagined that a beating heart could be transplanted from one human being to another.